

# Abhinav Kaushik

Senior Data Scientist - Rankings & Recommendations

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September 27, 2026

Hiring Team

Holidu

## Re: Senior Data Scientist - Rankings & Recommendations

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Data Scientist role in Rankings & Recommendations at Holidu. As a data scientist I have built rerankers and recommendation models and taken them to production, alongside gradient boosting on tabular data. The thread through my work is deciding what someone should see first, and checking that the choice helped.

Holidu's search has to balance relevance, conversion and business value while a large share of homes are new and most visitors are anonymous. Those cold-start and personalisation problems are exactly the ones I want to work on. My fiancée lives in Berlin, and we plan to move to Munich together and settle there long term.

I would bring ranking experience and production care. At Optum I added a reranker to a plan recommendation system that increased conversion by 2%. More recently I fine-tuned a cross-encoder to re-rank dense retrieval, and at Viavi I ran a LightGBM prediction system with MLflow that cut downtime by 67%.

Outside work I am building ThinkTree.AI, a non-profit AI learning platform used by NGO teachers to support students with ADHD. It has taught me to let real usage decide what stays. I would be glad to talk about where I could help Search Intelligence next.

Sincerely,

Abhinav Kaushik